

NEOM SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY REPORT 2023

A CHANGE TODAY

ABOUT NEOM SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

Who We Are

NEOM SR is the main enabler, facilitator, and motivator of achieving NEOM's social responsibility vision and promoting a culture that inspires all NEOM sectors, departments, partners and individuals to take action through embracing responsible economic, environmental and social practices and initiatives that achieve sustained impact.

Mission

Inspiring the world by leading the future of responsible communities with practices and initiatives that identify and address stakeholder values innovatively in a human-centric manner that accelerates and sustains socio-economic engagement and elevates quality of life.

Our Tracks

NEOM SR LEAD strategy objectives include leveraging partnership opportunities, empowering community and individuals, accelerating economic diversification and driving long-term value. NEOM's Social Responsibility programs and initiatives are designed to create value for all stakeholders, placing them at the heart of responsible operations and making them partners in achieving development within three primary tracks:

- Accelerating Progress
- Embedding Value
- Enhancing Quality of Life

ABOUT THIS REPORT

Building on NEOM SR's reports for 2021 and 2022, we are delighted to present the 2023 report. This is the first of five annual publications representing NEOM SR's five-year strategy, called LEAD (2023–2027). With this report, we invite you to explore a remarkable journey driven by a development strategy that will transform social responsibility practices and initiatives worldwide. Within these pages, the voices of the people of NEOM and Tabuk, NEOM sectors, volunteers and partners emerge as they are more empowered by NEOM SR's mission to lead the future of socially responsible communities.

Availability

This report covers NEOM SR programs and initiatives throughout one calendar year, extending from January 1, 2023 until December 31, 2023. In accordance with NEOM's commitment to sustainability, this report has been prepared with the planet in mind and is accessible in digital format, ensuring minimal ecological impact.

Report Highlights

Our People: Experience NEOM SR's journey through the eyes of entrepreneurs, strategic partners, beneficiaries, NEOM employees and volunteers sharing their stories through engaging articles and enthusiastic

interviews and visuals.

Our Programs and Initiatives: Gain insights on the positive impacts of these people-inspired programs designed for a wide range of beneficiaries, from entrepreneurs to students and volunteers, on the NEOM and Tabuk communities through entrepreneurial and small and medium enterprise (SME) support, increased opportunities for high-quality education and volunteering and philanthropic activities.

Accessibility and Usability

NEOM SR 2023 report is designed to reach more audiences and improve usability. The report is enhanced with QR codes introducing new sections to reach more readers. The audio feature enhances the report's accessibility to more audiences.

2023 MILESTONES

50K+ — overall beneficiaries
40M+ SAR — return to the local community
583 — individuals hired from NEOM and Tabuk region
68 — completed volunteering opportunities
26+ — projects awarded by NEOM
1,300+ — volunteers
50 — programs & initiatives
1 — NEOM Social Responsibility Award
5,000+ — total career counseling services (mock job interviews, CV writing, career path consultation)

AWARDS

- NEOM presented with the Prince Fahd bin Sultan Award for Scientific Excellence
- NEOM wins National Award for Voluntary Work from the Ministry of Human Resources and Social Development

INTRODUCTION BY THE CEO

A home for people who dream big, NEOM envisions creating a lasting legacy for our people and the communities we serve. This vision emanates from a deep understanding of the social structure and a strong sense of duty toward our role as change-makers in our community.

Our unwavering commitment to social responsibility, sustainability, and innovation is deep-rooted in our strategy as well as our identity, envisioned by His Royal Highness Mohammed bin Salman, Crown Prince and Chairman of the NEOM Board of Directors. This commitment runs through the core of our entire organization. It permeates every aspect of our mission, reflecting a broader goal of becoming a world-class innovation hub led by the brightest minds and best talent and a global model for economic, social, and environmental sustainability, in line with the national roadmap, Saudi Vision 2030.

NEOM's SR department has reinforced this commitment through its strategy which is founded on four pillars: leveraging partnership opportunities, empowering community and individuals, accelerating economic diversification, and driving long-term values. A common theme among these pillars is instilling the values of participation and cooperation among everyone in what serves society, an endeavor that NEOM prides itself for driving successfully in various ways.

The scope of our vision extends beyond our current and upcoming projects and initiatives as we continue to promote this universal culture that is brought to life by our diverse teams of dreamers and doers who want to be part of building a new model for exceptional livability in harmony with nature. Our teams actively engage in

improving the lives of individuals, families, and communities through impactful initiatives across multiple fields, inspired by our values and adhering to the highest organizational standards embedded within our strategies.

Championed by the people of our SR team and individuals from NEOM's diverse sectors, subsidiaries, partners, and community, this holistic approach reflects our promise to act now to improve our present and pave the way for a brighter future – catalyzing a change today that will lay the groundwork for a promising tomorrow.

— Nadhmi Al-Nasr, NEOM CEO

A WELCOME MESSAGE FROM NEOM SR

Our team understands that true success lies in transforming lives through creating opportunities for growth and prosperity for our communities. It is with great enthusiasm and a sense of purpose we present our Social Responsibility report for 2023. Through its theme of Human-Centric Growth, the report details the programs and initiatives we undertook throughout the first year of NEOM SR's five-year strategy to achieve 'A Change Today'.

Driven by a shared commitment to making positive, lasting and meaningful impacts on our communities, we are honored to contribute to the remarkable journey of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, led by the progressive Saudi Vision 2030 agenda. We actively listen and respond to our stakeholders, ensuring that they are part of the process as we aim to nurture a culture of social responsibility.

Dedicated to consistently communicating and reporting the results of our initiatives and programs, we have adopted world-class standards for documenting our actions to ensure our stakeholders can fully experience the impact we strive to achieve together.

Our goal is to become a catalyst for collaboration with our internal and external partners, individuals, departments and entities, laying the foundation for a better tomorrow, knowing that implementing change today positively shapes our community's future.

We are thankful for all those who contributed to the success of our collaborative social programs and initiatives in 2023, and look forward to working together as we continue to drive positive change and create a better world for all.

— NEOM Social Responsibility Department

OUR SR STORY UNFOLDS — 2023: A YEAR OF STRATEGIC ACTION

NEOM's journey toward socially responsible communities continues to evolve, marked by a responsible commitment to sustainable impact by creating a culture that can achieve long-lasting value for generations to come.

In 2023, NEOM embraced new ways to elevate several components of the social responsibility strategy and continued to leverage its resources to serve four social responsibility goals: Leveraging Partnership Opportunities, Empowering Community and Individuals, Accelerating Economic Diversification and Driving Long-term Value.

The enhancements were paced to the needs of all NEOM stakeholders. Key focus areas included harnessing the power of improved processes and fluid communication systems to increase community activities and engagement. This ensured quality interactions that could drive future initiatives through gaining insights and feedback and building lasting connections with all stakeholders.

Human-Centricity

As an accelerator of human progress, NEOM upholds its commitment to social responsibility, fostering positive impact and enabling sustainable development through community-driven initiatives. Believing in the power of people to induce change, NEOM set about to empower them with novel skills, knowledge and resources, preparing them to champion transformative initiatives that will inspire more activists to join in. Programs and initiatives were crafted with this human-centricity in mind through a complementary approach that facilitates and motivates genuine people-led growth.

Building Stronger Connections

At the heart of NEOM's SR strategy lies an enduring connection with the local community. In 2023, flagship career events, entrepreneurship programs and educational and youth empowerment initiatives brought valuable opportunities to interact with stakeholders and gain valuable insights and feedback. By working hand in hand with the local community, NEOM continued to build trust, ensuring that all initiatives are in tune with the genuine needs and aspirations of the people they serve.

In the transformational narrative of NEOM's social responsibility, 2023 was a year of human-centered action through increased community engagement and more powerful connections. NEOM continues to advance this mission, extending an open invitation for all stakeholders to join in shaping a better future defined by progress, development and sustainable growth for all.

TRACK 1: ACCELERATING PROGRESS — Empowering Our Communities

NEOM's role as an accelerator of human progress converges with its goal of driving innovation and economic diversification through 14 sectors. On a more profound level, NEOM is a driving force for the empowerment of individuals and communities, enabling them to lead the way in shaping a sustainable future. Through focused initiatives and programs, NEOM SR is establishing the groundwork for significant socio-economic innovation introducing new concepts and approaches that not only drive economic growth and prosperity but also address social and societal challenges.

NEOM Seven Senses Program

The NEOM Seven Senses Program remains committed to accelerating progress and empowering entrepreneurship through an ecosystem where entrepreneurs from SMEs, craftspeople and freelancers can prosper and excel with the right resources, training and mentorship. This signature program encompasses six tracks: Seven Senses Accelerator, Seven Senses Masterclass, Seven Senses Hub, Seven Senses Micro-loans, Seven Senses Boulevard and Seven Senses Gate. The tracks were designed to create a thriving entrepreneurial ecosystem that connects local SMEs to the many opportunities in NEOM as trusted vendors in areas such as culture and tourism, construction, logistics and event management.

Within the framework of the NEOM Seven Senses Program tracks, NEOM SR is dedicated to enhancing the entrepreneurial infrastructure in NEOM and Tabuk, with a vision to extend its support for entrepreneurs beyond the confines of NEOM and Tabuk, driving growth and expansion across Saudi Arabia in line with NEOM's global vision.

1. NEOM Seven Senses Accelerator

NEOM Seven Senses Accelerator and Bootcamp empower SME owners, freelancers, creatives and artisans by imparting essential knowledge and skills. In the 2023 cohort, 173 entrepreneurs underwent a two-day bootcamp, mastering successful business basics, customer understanding and investor presentation. More than 150 companies pitched for a spot in the Accelerator, which commenced with a 10-week intensive business and creative curriculum. In October, 38 beneficiaries successfully graduated from the track, securing more than 10

NEOM contracts.

Goals:

- Foster the growth of the entrepreneurial ecosystem in the Tabuk region
- Establish connections between stakeholders and NEOM sectors
- Engage the local community with world-class expertise

Beneficiaries:

693 — registration requests
173 — bootcamp participants
38 — accelerator participants
78 — consultation hours
38 — focused workshops

2. NEOM Seven Senses Masterclass

The NEOM Seven Senses Masterclass is an online platform revolutionizing digital entrepreneurship with tailored Arabic content. In 2023, the platform provided free access and served 1,087 registered beneficiaries, offering 20 different courses to empower aspiring and existing entrepreneurs. This virtual masterclass featured video lectures, interactive activities and insights from Saudi Arabia's leading business experts, consultants and startup builders, serving as a dynamic space for knowledge, skills and community building in the pursuit of successful business ventures.

Goals:

- Provide enablement tools for young entrepreneurs
- Showcase success stories and inspire entrepreneurs from the Kingdom
- Facilitate access to world-class sessions
- Enrich the Arabic content available in the entrepreneurship field
- Ensure accessibility, including sign language, to expert-led virtual classes at anytime and anywhere in Saudi Arabia

Beneficiaries:

1,087 — beneficiaries
20 — courses to empower entrepreneurs

3. NEOM Seven Senses Micro-Loans

NEOM Seven Senses Micro-loans is a socio-economic initiative designed specifically for women, through a collaboration with the Social Development Bank and Jana Center, and offering lending services to spur growth. The track strives to instill a culture of production, addressing the financial needs of the local community and unemployment. Currently empowering 613 women through viable income-generating social projects, this program contributes to social and economic development, fostering a positive impact on the local economy.

Goal:

- To empower female beneficiaries economically and socially and generate a developmental impact by providing financial and non-financial services according to best practices
- 613 — number of direct beneficiaries

4. NEOM Seven Senses Hub

The NEOM Seven Senses Hub provides co-working spaces and production labs to empower local entrepreneurs from NEOM and Tabuk. These facilities currently supply 38 entrepreneurs with the essential equipment and resources needed to effectively manage and run their businesses. Within this space, the Hub offers three production labs specifically designed for local craftsmen to create their products. These labs have a primary goal of offering robust support and development programs for artisans, enabling them to grow and extend their reach across the entire Kingdom.

The Hub features a concept store offering a space where NEOM Seven Senses collaborates with talented creators and artisans from NEOM and Tabuk to offer a diverse range of unique and exclusive products fusing beauty, innovation and heritage. The store also unlocks new opportunities for growth for businesses in the NEOM and Tabuk regions.

38 — entrepreneurs from NEOM and Tabuk

5. NEOM Seven Senses Boulevard

The NEOM Seven Senses Boulevard is a vibrant social and entertainment event launched to connect entrepreneurs with NEOM communities. The event provided a space for showcasing the products and services of artisans, as well as SMEs from the NEOM Seven Senses Accelerator, young aspiring entrepreneurs and Seven Senses Micro-loan beneficiaries.

The inaugural NEOM Seven Senses Boulevard was organized by Rowina, a local startup specializing in event planning and organization and entertainment. The event immersed over 3,000 enthusiastic visitors in a lively atmosphere filled with excitement and entertainment, allowing them to discover the incredible work of over 40 artisans, SMEs and micro-loan beneficiaries.

The two-week event provided a unique platform to engage with NEOM employees and their families, enhancing the marketing potential for local SMEs. With more than 148,000 SAR in sales generated for participants and young entrepreneurs, some small companies even secured contracts beyond the confines of the exhibit. Cultivating an entrepreneurial spirit among the younger members of the communities, NEOM Seven Senses Boulevard offered 37 young merchants early exposure to the dynamic business world.

Boulevard 2023 Highlights:

3,000+ — visitors
40 — participants
6 — partners
18 — workshops
37 — young merchants (children of NEOM employees)
148,000 SAR — total sales
320 — volunteering hours
18 — volunteers

6. NEOM Seven Senses Gate

NEOM Seven Senses Gate is designed to provide commercial and professional opportunities and sales channels for the NEOM Seven Senses Program beneficiaries. Launching 16 e-commerce platforms in 2023 with 100 products, the track offers local beneficiaries significant market outreach opportunities including contracts with NEOM sectors and unlocks marketplaces for them across the NEOM and Tabuk regions. More than 26 contracts were awarded to local companies, including Rowina Media Production, Laqta Media Production and Miss Dana.

16 — e-commerce stores
100 — products
+26 — contracts
13 — Food Trucks

Partner Interview: Blossom — Igniting Entrepreneurial Possibilities

Blossom, a crucial partner of NEOM SR, stands at the forefront of contributors to NEOM Seven Senses by shaping innovation within the entrepreneurial landscape. The remarkable journey of its Founder and CEO Eman Shakoor, evolving from a neuroscience researcher to a technology entrepreneur and startup advisor, is a testament to her unwavering dedication to community advancement through supporting women-led businesses.

Q1: Blossom Accelerator is dedicated to guiding startups and helping them secure critical seed-stage funding. We take pride in being Saudi Arabia's pioneering tech-inclusion and female-focused accelerator. Our goal is to empower founders, granting them access to community, educational resources and curated investment opportunities. Inclusivity, for us, is about creating an environment where innovation, economic growth and female empowerment intersect in the tech landscape.

Q2: Blossom's collaboration with NEOM is not new; Blossom previously worked with Oxagon. Our shared goal is to create a robust entrepreneurial environment in the NEOM and Tabuk regions, supporting SMEs, freelancers and artisans. The impact has been substantial, with over 500 beneficiaries, and we remain dedicated to enhancing the entrepreneurial landscape in the region through continued collaboration.

Q3: Our overarching goal is to empower thousands of Saudi businesses, facilitating their access to investors and fostering collaboration for expansion. This vision not only contributes to the prosperity of our economy but also sets the stage for more Saudi companies to take off and thrive.

Success Stories

Njoud Al Balawi — Founder, RC Abaya

Growing up, Njoud always dreamed of making her mark in the world of Saudi fashion. She started her own workshop in 2019 with a loan from Riyadhah Program. When COVID-19 hit, she faced mounting debt and rising operational costs. Rather than giving up, she focused on manufacturing abayas. The NEOM Seven Senses Program helped her regain control, refine her strategy and take her brand to new heights. Thanks to the program, she showcased her work at the NEOM Seven Senses Boulevard and landed a major order. She now envisions opening a larger clothing factory in Tabuk, specializing in abayas and uniforms.

Omar Al Rayess — Co-founder, Maqtura

Inspired by a love for creativity and entrepreneurship, Omar co-founded a boutique creative media production and photography studio called Maqtura in Tabuk. Through NEOM Seven Senses program's business workshops, he enriched his knowledge and refined his vision. He secured a place in the NEOM Seven Senses Boulevard and delivered photography and presentation design services. Maqtura Studio is now charting a strategic course to become one of the leading content creators in the NEOM and Tabuk regions.

Atallah Al Atawi — Founder, Arabia Trail Ltd.

Atallah's journey began in 2018 as a licensed tour guide. In 2021 he founded Madian Tours. With the support of NEOM Seven Senses Program, Arabia Trail now delivers top-notch experiences and world-class services for international companies and VIP guests. He envisions Arabia Trail becoming a key player in the local tourism industry, not only in NEOM and Tabuk, but across the entire Kingdom.

Tajseer Training Program

The Tajseer Training Program, launched in collaboration with the Social Development Bank, forms a crucial aspect of NEOM SR's 2023 improvement plan, specifically designed to empower beneficiaries of NEOM Seven Senses Micro-Loans. Its primary objective is to elevate business quality and foster growth by implementing targeted training and establishing strategic local partnerships. The program benefitted 91 female trainees, aiming to facilitate the growth of their businesses.

Goals:

- Empowering SMEs to achieve growth and long-term sustainability
- Providing financial support to beneficiaries through local outlets and partnerships
- Building and empowering local capacity

91 — trainees

NPO Empowerment

The NPO Empowerment program has been strategically designed to foster the growth and development of Non-Profit Organizations (NPOs) in NEOM and Tabuk. This program is structured into three phases: (1) Conducting a comprehensive study of local NPOs, (2) Enacting a leadership program designed to enhance leadership capabilities, (3) Empowering NPOs for overall progress.

NEOM SR has successfully implemented the first and second phases in collaboration with the King Khalid Foundation to identify and address areas for development for 25 leaders from 11 NPOs.

Phases Implemented:

- 11 NPOs were evaluated
- 25 leaders participated in the training sessions

Community Initiatives:

- Providing female students from Al Badaa with transportation services to Tabuk University branch in Haql
 - Joining a charity workshop in Duba and engaging in collaborative efforts to identify challenges
 - Collaborating with the Sport sector to donate revenue from NEOM Beach Games ticket sales to charity
 - Supporting beneficiaries of Non-Profit Organizations through in-kind support programs
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TRACK 2: ENHANCING QUALITY OF LIFE — Paving the Path to Fulfillment

Enhancing Quality of Life is an integral part of the overarching NEOM SR vision, creating channels for the ongoing progression of socio-economic development, and the opportunity for exceptional livability in harmony with nature. This track's initiatives and programs further provide the foundation for widespread individual well-being and societal contentment and establish essential links toward a prosperous community.

Career Counseling Program (Signature Program)

The Career Counseling Program embodies NEOM's commitment by supporting members of the local communities to secure jobs across diverse occupations and career paths through its network of connections with 170 companies. The signature program champions proactive solutions by equipping young men and women from the NEOM and Tabuk regions with the essential tools to navigate the job market.

The program includes: (1) Career Path Training, (2) Social Employment Platform, (3) NEOM Partners Job Fair.

Career Path Training — Key Achievements:

Through three career coaching tracks, the program provided 5,068 services to more than 1,700 trainees in 2023, including personalized recommendations, simulated real interview scenarios and guidance for crafting standout resumes.

- +1,700 — trainees supported
- 3 — types of services
- +5,000 — services offered

NEOM Partners Workshop

The Career Counseling Program held a workshop titled 'Responsible Partners for a Sustainable Future' in partnership with the Local Content Department and the Project Department. The session was attended by 32 of NEOM's partners, advocating the culture of social responsibility at NEOM.

- 32 — participants
- 24 — volunteering hours

NEOM Partners Job Fair

NEOM has set a new standard for employment exhibitions with the NEOM Partners Job Fair. The 2023 offering revolutionized the job fair experience for both job seekers and employers. The two-day event enabled job seekers to seamlessly submit their applications on-site and brought 21 companies face-to-face with potential talent in the NEOM and Tabuk regions.

The NEOM Partners Job Fair attracted 3,059 visitors and had a direct positive impact on the lives of local individuals, with 583 landing job placements. NEOM Friends volunteers helped organize the forum.

Event Highlights:

- 3,059 — visitors
- 1,620 — job opportunities
- 1,594 — virtual interviews
- 17 — volunteers
- 1,280 — services at career centre zone
- 583 — job placements
- 1,444 — onsite interviews
- 306 — volunteering hours

Career Counseling Success Stories

NEOM's Career Counseling Program has been instrumental in transforming the career trajectories of local talent in the NEOM and Tabuk regions. In 2023, the program's initiatives empowered 2,361 individuals to navigate the competitive job market, directly assisting 583 of them to secure positions with leading local and international companies affiliated with NEOM.

Habib Al Samiti

After facing challenges securing a job in his field after graduation, Habib learned about NEOM Partners Job Fair and applied for a Procurement Department Engineer position at Nesma Company. He was accepted into his first job, which gave him financial independence. His skills grew exponentially, enabling him to handle high-value purchase orders for large-scale projects like Oxagon and Trojena.

Abdullah Alshehri

After graduating from Tabuk University with a degree in Business Administration, Abdullah's career took a significant turn after his journey with the Career Counseling Program. He discovered his passion for human resources, attended numerous HR courses and workshops, and was offered the position of HR Coordinator at Nesma Company after impressing the recruitment manager at the NEOM Partners Job Fair.

NEOM Scholarship Program

The NEOM Scholarship Program is a forward-looking initiative to empower high school graduates from the local communities of NEOM and Tabuk to join top international and national universities, ultimately leading to employment opportunities within NEOM sectors or with NEOM partners. Since its launch, the program has supported 740 students.

In 2023, NEOM witnessed the completion of the NEOM Scholarship Program Policy and Procedures and the establishment of the Scholarship Program Committee (SPC) and Scholarship Management Committee (SMT). The program achieved closer alignment with the workforce demand for 19 sectors and departments in NEOM, and launched the Education Hub, a dedicated portal for students.

Achievements:

- 740 — total beneficiaries
- 163 — international scholarship students in the UK and USA
- 411 — national scholarship students
- 166 — foundation year students
- 30 — students to join Ministry of Education's IMDAD program

Goals:

- Facilitating access to education and employment opportunities for school graduates in NEOM and Tabuk
- Empowering students to be future leaders in NEOM projects
- Cultivating a socially responsible workforce

Pre-Scholarship Programs

Foundation Year: As part of the scholarship admission process, the NEOM Scholarship Program offers a one-year preparatory program in collaboration with Fahd Bin Sultan University. In 2023, enhancements included improved admission criteria, customized science and non-science tracks, AP courses in international tracks, an IELTS preparation program with English First, and launch of the NEOM Scholarship portal (Education Hub).

Enrichment Program: Designed to provide students from the NEOM and Tabuk region with the opportunity to prepare early and develop their skills to meet the NEOM Scholarship Program's specific criteria. The 10-week program offered weekly sessions for 400 high school senior-year students.

Training Initiative

The NEOM Scholarship Program prioritizes collaborative training with partners offering specialized courses. Key achievements include: launching a NEOM skills training program for Foundation Year students; issuing 908 training certificates in various fields; training 818 students through HADAF; discovering and supporting 62 talents through the Mawhiba Empowerment Program; and participating in the Wise Conference with a research proposal on the use of Artificial Intelligence to improve intercultural competence.

Sector Engagement (Post-Scholarship)

Designed to inspire the next generation of Saudi leaders, the Sector Engagement initiative provides scholarship recipients with internships and immersive site visits to cutting-edge projects. In 2023, Trojena, Oxagon, Health and Wellbeing, Sport, and Tourism sectors received students. ENOWA provided various opportunities including sending students to the Extreme-E event in Italy, an ENOWA Hackathon at NEOM, a Smart Grid conference in Riyadh, and offering internship positions.

Success Story: Anas Al Ghamdi

From early days tinkering with technology, Anas taught himself programming and hacking at the age of 12. In 2020, he was accepted into the NEOM Scholarship Program. He excelled in cybersecurity and won top prizes in major international competitions like CyberK, where he secured first place in his category. In recognition of the program, he created a website to help students access information easily, enhancing the efficiency of student selection, registration and capability development processes for NEOM.

CEO Launches NEOM Scholarship Program Center in Tabuk

NEOM CEO Nadhmi Al Nasr inaugurated the NEOM Scholarship Program Center at Prince Fahad bin Sultan University, leading a delegation of the heads of sectors at NEOM. The visit celebrated the successful launch of the National Scholarship Center, a hub where the Program's community can connect and inspire progress through their accomplishments.

17 — volunteers

68 — volunteering hours

NEOM Tabuk Forum 2023

A platform for inspiration and networking, the NEOM Tabuk Forum brought valuable opportunities for NEOM and the local communities in Tabuk. The vibrant event offered a unique opportunity for NEOM and Tabuk communities to explore the prospects that will be accessible to them through interacting with various sectors in NEOM.

The event featured three distinct zones: 'Inspiration' showcasing images and models of NEOM regions; a zone dedicated to success stories; and a third zone offering a space for 11 NEOM sectors to interact with the region's residents, introducing training opportunities across tourism, media and HR. The event included 14 seminars and workshops.

2,788 — visitors
14 — seminars
14 — workshops
10 — stakeholders
5 — local businesses
12 — volunteers
175 — volunteering hours

National Day in Al Badaa

NEOM SR hosted the 93rd Saudi National Day in Al Badaa, emphasizing a strong commitment to fostering community engagement and celebrating heritage and national identity. The event attracted 4,800 guests and featured several activities. Students from Al Badaa had the opportunity to develop their artistic skills, joining art workshops and participating in the National Day painting alongside professional artists.

4,800+ — visitors
10 — volunteers
35 — volunteering hours
20 — accompanying events
10 — productive families
22 — participating artists

HAWI Student Clubs

NEOM collaborated with Saudi Vision 2030's Quality of Life Program to launch HAWI student clubs, a new initiative to empower and inspire individuals with talents and hobbies in the NEOM and Tabuk regions. The first HAWI edition was held in collaboration with Prince Fahd Bin Sultan University in Tabuk. The project offered 350 students the opportunity to join one of seven clubs:

- Social Responsibility and Sustainability Club
- Film and Photography Club
- Student Tourist Guidance Club
- Adventure Sports Club
- Padel Club
- Cultural Tourism Experiences Club for Heritage Hobby
- Electronic Games Club

Philanthropy Kits

Philanthropy Kits represent NEOM SR's fundamental commitment to creating tangible changes in people's lives, advancing equality and justice, and nurturing a society that is both more inclusive and compassionate. This initiative supports individuals in need by providing them with resources and essential tools customized to help them overcome various challenges.

School Kits

The initiative aims to strengthen social cohesion within the NEOM community by providing school bags equipped with essential supplies to charitable organizations, supporting the education of 3,000 students. NEOM Friends volunteers participated in preparing 300 school bags.

3,000 — students
41 — volunteers

123 — volunteering hours

Winter Kits

The initiative aims to make a positive impact by distributing winter kits to beneficiaries of charities within the NEOM and Tabuk region. By supporting 2,200 families, the initiative underscores the commitment to supporting families in the region and promoting the community's preparedness in the face of seasonal challenges.

2,200 — kits distributed

Ramadan Coupons

NEOM SR distributed 1,000 vouchers to families registered in the TANMIAH and charitable organizations programs in NEOM and Tabuk regions to support these families in meeting their needs for the Holy Month of Ramadan, providing them with a shopping voucher at local supermarkets.

1,000 — families

Maqaad

The Maqaad initiative aims to raise awareness and encourages parents to use car seats when traveling with children and facilitates the distribution of car seats, aiming to improve road safety in the Kingdom in line with Saudi Vision 2030. This initiative was represented by the SR Department in NEOM, in cooperation with the Emirate of Tabuk Province, the Ministry of Health, and the 'Maqaad Endowment' Foundation.

10,000 — seats for children and newborns

Open Day

As part of the Open Day organized by the Community Services team within NEOM, communities had the opportunity to foster interaction between NEOM sectors and individuals. NEOM SR participated in an exhibition to raise awareness of the social responsibility culture and introduce employees and their families to its programs.

1,200+ — attendants

78 — booths run by diverse departments, sectors and individuals

TRACK 3: EMBEDDING VALUE — Connecting Lives

NEOM SR consistently implements and evaluates strategic engagement approaches to enhance positive impacts within its communities. The Embedding Value Track, defined by a spectrum of ongoing social and environmental volunteering programs and talent-building initiatives, mobilizes and activates the diverse talents of its people in service of others, cultivating the collaborative effort needed to build a stronger and more resilient community together.

NEOM Friends (Signature Program)

NEOM Friends provides innovative and enjoyable volunteering opportunities, enriching the lives of both participants and beneficiaries. The program aims to cultivate a culture of giving back through systematic integration, creating a diverse environment that places the needs and capabilities of its people at the forefront of activity planning and decision-making processes.

This year, NEOM Friends actively collaborated with different NEOM sectors, regions, and departments. Their hands-on participation not only shaped the program but also led its initiatives to become deeper and more specialized. This embodies the principle of solidarity within NEOM and reflects its commitment to making a positive impact for all stakeholders.

This signature program primarily targets NEOM's internal community, encompassing employees and their families, and extends its reach to the broader external community and partners, engaging volunteers throughout the Tabuk region.

Key Figures:

38 — Completed Initiatives
935 — Volunteers
24,314 — Beneficiaries
4,965 — Volunteer hours
35 — Partners

Signature Initiatives:

- Touristic Areas Clean Up Initiatives
- NEOM Green Initiatives
- Paramedic Champion Initiatives
- Blood Donation
- Read with NEOM

The National Award of Volunteer Work

NEOM Friends, a flagship initiative under NEOM SR, has secured the first position in the National Award for Voluntary Work - third edition. The award, presented by the Ministry of Human Resources and Social Development, acknowledges NEOM as the 'Leading Entity in Activating Volunteer Work for Organizations.'

His Excellency, the Minister of Human Resources and Social Development, Eng. Ahmad bin Sulaiman Al-Rajhi, recognized NEOM's excellence in organizing and actively engaging in impactful volunteer work throughout 2023.

Volunteer Success Stories

Salima Rahim

Leaving behind the familiarity of home in South Africa, Salima's family embarked on a journey to NEOM, where the challenge of adapting to a new environment soon transformed into a spiritually enriching experience thanks to the welcoming embrace of NEOM Friends. The program helped her overcome language differences and other personal challenges. One particularly memorable event was 'Children with Down Syndrome in Tabuk,' which reinforced her desire to create a positive impact. NEOM Friends gave her the chance to contribute to changing the lives of others.

Bader Al Jishi

During his first week working in NEOM, Bader discovered his passion for volunteering through NEOM Friends. He found that volunteering helped him develop his character and discover his abilities and skills. Through networking opportunities with friends from all over the world and seeing the impact on the community, he discovered that volunteering isn't just about giving — the success of the community is linked to the success of its people.

Sultan Al Harbi

Volunteering was not very well-known in Sultan's community, but through NEOM SR, he learned about the culture of volunteering and joined NEOM Friends. Through effective communication with diverse cultures, he gained more life experience, contributing to his personal growth. One initiative he particularly values is the 'Orphan Day,' which strengthened his passion for giving.

Mashari Al-Shammari

As an enthusiastic volunteer, Mashari participated in volunteering initiatives for over 450 hours in 2023. He sees volunteering as an effective and immense force for positive change, through which you learn things you wouldn't learn elsewhere — including the meaning of giving and the profound impact a simple smile can have on those around you.

Reema Al Fakhri

Yearning to give back to her community, Reema found in NEOM Friends not only the opportunity but also the empowerment to foster an enduring impact. She views volunteering as not merely fulfilling hours of work, but about belonging, motivation, self-improvement, and personal development. NEOM Friends stands as a shining example of the transformative power of collective volunteerism.

Social Responsibility Award

NEOM Social Responsibility launched the Social Responsibility Award in 2023 as a tool to highlight and honor the best practices that contribute to achieving social responsibility. Recognizing outstanding institutional and individual practices, this accolade honors sectors, companies, and individuals within NEOM who demonstrate commitment, contribution, and responsibility towards the benefit of all societal segments.

Award Objectives:

- Enhance the importance of social responsibility and embed it within individuals, sectors and partners of NEOM
- Incentivize responsible entities and influential individuals, honoring their efforts in establishing a culture of social responsibility
- Develop institutional and individual social initiatives and practices to make a change today and lead the future

Winners:

NEOM Sectors Award Category: NEOM Operations, THE LINE Proponent, OXAGON

NEOM Partners Award Category: Nesma and Partners, Ernst and Young, King Fahad University of Petroleum and Minerals (KFUPM)

NEOM Individuals — Local Community Category: Sultan Alharbi, Reema Alfakhri, Anas Alshafi

NEOM Community School Students Category: Ammaarah Rahim, Aritom Pokidysev, Naadhirah Rahim

NEOM Families Category: Salima Rahim, Gunay Aghayeva, Juanita van Tonder

NEOM Employees Category: Bader Aljishi, Waleed BinSalman, Farida Qtaishat

NEOM Partners Employees Category: Thadickal V. Joydas

SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY IN NEOM DNA

The culture of social responsibility flows through every dimension of NEOM, embodying a shared commitment to socioeconomic progress and wellbeing. This section illustrates the collaborative efforts of NEOM's sectors, demonstrating how each plays a pivotal role in accelerating progress, enhancing the quality of life and embedding long-lasting value for the communities of NEOM and Tabuk.

Human Resources — Day One

This interactive educational program, launched through a collaboration with Misk, is designed to assist high school students in making informed and optimal career choices. By providing six students with a simulation of various job settings, the program enhanced the students' understanding of the job market, allowing them to recognize and utilize their skills and talents effectively.

9 — Mentors from NEOM GrOW
9 — volunteers
72 — volunteering hours

GrOW — Talent Management Program

Over the past two years, NEOM implemented the flagship talent management program, GrOW, to nurture leadership from within, where candidates are appointed from the first day as full-time employees. Designed to attract top Saudi graduates from local and global universities, the program features tailored learning experiences, mentoring and coaching and an innovative, AI-enhanced rigorous recruitment experience. In 2023, the onboarding team at NEOM HR successfully integrated 123 GrOW candidates.

35,000+ — total applications
123 — GrOW candidates onboarded in 2023
186 — GrOW candidates onboarded in two years

NEOM Hotel Division — ZADK Culinary Academy

The NEOM Culinary Arts Program by NEOM Hotel Division provides opportunities for students from the NEOM and Tabuk communities to become professional chefs within NEOM projects. Through a collaboration with ZADK Academy, the two-year program offers students a specialized international diploma in culinary arts. Launched in 2022, the program blends culinary and pastry skills with crucial professional tools like English Language and Communication.

During 2023, nine NEOM-sponsored students from the program's first batch completed their required internship abroad — a first for ZADK Academy. The NEOM Hotel Division team chose Marriott as their inaugural partner. The goal is to equip students with the necessary skills required for employment at the Marriott Hotel on Sindalah Island upon their graduation.

9 — students

Nature Reserve — Rangers

NEOM Rangers are the frontline personnel responsible for monitoring and protecting the natural resources and wildlife within NEOM. They enforce regulations related to conservation, including preventing poaching, habitat destruction and other illegal activities. In addition, they collect data, conduct patrols and report on the status of biodiversity and habitat.

In 2023, Rangers program Phase 1 was launched, and a total of 38 rangers were enrolled in an advanced six-month field training camp designed, developed, and delivered by South Africa Wildlife College (SAWC). The training camp develops the rangers' skills in protecting the reserves on land and underwater.

Sport — Shuhub

Building on the success of Shuhub 2022, the second edition of Shuhub was held in collaboration with Fahad Bin Sultan University (FBSU) and NEOM Sport sector, offering world-class football training experiences for children aged six to 12. The program is designed to foster skill development, provide essential knowledge of the game and identify growing talent in the region. The initiative was organized in two phases during 2023 and concluded with an event attended by 1,461 children with their families.

711 — children phase 1 2023
750 — children phase 2 2023
61 — volunteers
1,558 — volunteering hours

NEOM Beach Games

Building on the success of the 2022 edition, the NEOM Sport Events team continued its collaboration with NEOM SR to provide opportunities for NEOM and Tabuk communities to attend the NEOM Beach Games. Revenue generated from ticket sales was donated to nine local charities in NEOM and Tabuk enabling them to sustain their programs.

This year's event saw the introduction of the NEOM Beach Games Volunteers Program with 50 volunteers from NEOM community helping to ensure a smooth and enjoyable event. The NEOM Beach Games once again provided a unique opportunity to develop future champions in Saudi Arabia.

14,000 — Tickets for NEOM and Tabuk communities
9 — Tabuk charities

Heritage — Graffiti Cleaning Program

NEOM Heritage and the Royal Commission for AlUla (RCU) have joined forces to address the nation-wide problem of graffiti and vandalism on and around heritage sites across both regions. In 2023, NEOM Heritage launched an inaugural eight-week program in Bajdah to train local conservation specialists on non-invasive skills to clean heritage sites against graffiti, including laser-cleaning, micro sandblasting and selective chemical treatment. Simultaneously, NEOM Heritage and RCU are preparing an awareness campaign to educate local and national communities about the shared responsibility of safeguarding national treasures.

Procurement — Madinah Local Content Forum

NEOM demonstrated its dedication to local content and community support during its participation in the Industry and Local Content Forum held in AlMadinah from December 19th to 21st, 2023. NEOM's presence at the event was marked by an engaging booth that showcased the project's extensive efforts in fostering local content and social responsibility initiatives aimed at bolstering the communities within the NEOM and Tabuk regions and the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia overall.

Over the course of the three-day event, NEOM's booth attracted more than 1,200 visitors. A panel discussion featured Abdullah Al Masood, Executive Director of Strategic Sourcing and Local Content.

Tourism — Tour Operator & Tour Guide Development

As part of the ongoing commitment to upskill local tour operators and tour guides, the NEOM Tourism sector carried out a comprehensive training program aimed at ensuring safe practices in delivering tourism experiences in NEOM. Over three months, a total of 57 guides representing five local tour operators were trained across various courses, all aligned with international quality and safety standards.

Courses Delivered:

- Tour Guide Training
- First Aid Medical Training
- Hiking Guiding
- VIP Transportation
- R3 Rope Rescue accreditation
- RoSPA Defensive and Off-road Driving accreditations

Tourism Participation in NEOM Forum in Tabuk

The Second NEOM Forum in Tabuk included a two-day workshop on NEOM's rich cultural and natural heritage and the pivotal role that local tour guides play in sharing the region's unique stories and landscapes. In the month following the workshop, the Ministry of Tourism experienced an increase in applications for tour guide licenses in the Tabuk Region indicating the Forum's effectiveness in driving interest for career opportunities within the tourism sector.

Media — NEOM Forum: Empowering Local Talent in Media Industries

The Media Industries sector participated in the NEOM Forum held in Tabuk, aiming to forge stronger connections with local communities while offering invaluable learning opportunities. During the Forum, the sector received 80 applications to participate in industry learning programs. Subsequently, 20 individuals from Tabuk were selected to participate in comprehensive training courses spanning the full spectrum of the media industry.

Among the success stories, Khaled Alenezi gained hands-on experience in the screen production department, working on SBA's reality TV show 'Unbreakable'. Rakan Al Balawi joined the feature film 'Al Gaid' on set in Bajdah, along with enrolment in a six-month online training program with the National Film and Television School in the UK. The Media Industries sector is actively collaborating with approximately 300 individuals from Tabuk.

Oxagon — Hackathon

Oxagon held a three-day Hackathon in partnership with the Ministry of Education. The major tech event focused on leveraging technology for sustainability and the wellbeing of people, addressing global environmental challenges and potential solutions, including e-fuel and green hydrogen.

- 1,450 — participants
- 51% — female participation
- 27 — universities engaged
- 40 — cities in KSA
- 1,500+ — hours of hacking
- 200+ — mentoring sessions conducted
- 43 — mentors participated

Oxagon — Women Mentoring Group

Oxagon collaborated with NEOM Friends to empower women leaders through the Women Mentoring Group initiative. More than 30 women received training to navigate the work environment and tap into their strengths. The sessions resulted in creating value propositions and assisting female leaders in setting KPIs for 2024.

HSSE Recycling and Sustainability Training

The Port of NEOM Sustainability and Social Responsibility Department conducted a Health, Safety, Security & Environment workshop for 100 students from Duba School. The initiative supports NEOM's goal to raise environmentally responsible generations for a circular economy and socially responsible communities.

Oxagon — Local Artists Recycling Project

OXAGON collaborated with local artists to create art pieces from waste materials. The initiative aims to raise awareness and promote the conversation about waste recycling and sustainability. Around 30 artworks were created throughout the project and displayed in an art exhibition hosted at the Port of NEOM.

Oxagon Beach Clean-Up

Oxagon employees conducted two beach cleanup gatherings at nearby beaches. The first operation at the Port of NEOM beach included around 60 participants. The second session was held at the future Oxagon Village beach with around 25 participants.

SECTION 3: CONCLUSION — Shaping a Sustainable and Inclusive Future Through Social Responsibility

For another year, NEOM SR has demonstrated the effectiveness of its LEAD strategy, translating plans into tangible results through strategic implementation. The various components of the strategy, including Leveraging Partnership Opportunities, Empowering Community and Individuals, Accelerating Economic Diversification, and Driving Long-term Values, are instrumental in this transformation. Through these pillars, the five-year strategy ensures that every initiative and program is designed to make a meaningful impact, demonstrating five core values of NEOM SR: Human-Centric, Synergetic, Oriented, Transparent, Ethical.

In 2023, the enhanced focus on the human-centric aspect of the action plan highlighted NEOM SR's commitment to putting people at the center of its efforts, effectively driving positive change, and laying the foundation for a more sustainable and inclusive future.

The growing impact of NEOM SR's programs has been evident with a noticeable increase in beneficiaries and the expansion of initiatives, showcasing heightened strategic partnerships and community participation in ensuring their success. This growth reflects NEOM SR's commitment to empowering communities and individuals and involving them in shaping their futures.

This is only the beginning of a five-year story of meaningful change that will unfold one of NEOM SR's five core values each year from 2023 to 2027.

As NEOM SR looks toward the future, it remains dedicated to advancing its mission. Expanding on the success of 2023, NEOM SR will continue to champion practices and initiatives that address stakeholder values, accelerate and sustain socio-economic engagement and elevate quality of life to lead the future of responsible communities.

THANK YOU FROM NEOM

NEOM SR expresses its sincere gratitude to all stakeholders for their continued support and looks forward to further collaboration in the years to come. NEOM SR's initiatives would not have been possible without the dedication and commitment of NEOM employees, the partnership and cooperation of strategic partners, and the active participation and engagement of the communities of NEOM and Tabuk. Your collective efforts have made a meaningful impact, and we look forward to building on this foundation to continue to drive positive change for a brighter future for all.